

Designing a verifiable penalty

**1. Penalize a verifiable ACTION,
not lack of progress**

e.g. $-\lambda$ for 'rm -rf build/',
not for 'no progress this turn'

**2. Keep the outcome reward as the driver;
never optimize a penalty alone**

e.g. keep the 'ticket resolved' reward;
 $-\lambda$ over-call alone just stalls

**3. Pair the penalty with a DISCHARGE
(reward the compliant action)**

e.g. $+\beta$ when it authenticates
before placing the call

**4. Make the compliant path reachable
and its target un-gameable**

e.g. seed one 'read the access-
control file first' demonstration